# NEPQ Phase 4 — Solution Awareness

Cheat sheet · 5 Nov 2026

## Purpose

Move the prospect from **"I have a problem"** to **"I can see life with it solved, and I want it."** Knowing about a problem rarely makes people act; most wait until it becomes a crisis. Picturing the result is what creates urgency.

## Do / Don't

| Do | Don't |
|---|---|
| Let them describe their ideal outcome | Describe your product's features |
| Get both tangible and emotional benefits | Stop at logic ("more money") |
| Ask "what *does* it feel like" (present tense) | Ask "what *would* it feel like" (keeps it distant) |
| Let them measure the gap themselves | Tell them how far behind they are |

## The question flow

| Step | Example question |
|---|---|
| 1. Ideal criteria | "If you found the perfect solution, what would it need to have?" |
| 2. Tangible result | "If that problem was solved, what would change for you?" |
| 3. Emotional result | "And how does that feel, being there?" |
| 4. Visualise | "Picture it's 6 months from now and it's sorted. What does your day look like?" |
| 5. The gap | "How close are you to that right now?" |

**Future pacing:** paint two futures, one where it's solved and one where nothing changes. The tension between them is what drives action. The Consequences phase works the second future.

## Applied to TRB: gym owners, after pain discovery

Use **their** pain from Phase 3, in their words. Still no product. You are building the picture they will want to buy into later.

| Step | Gym owner version |
|---|---|
| Ideal criteria | "If you could fix [their pain], what would the ideal fix look like for you? What would it need to do?" |
| Tangible | "If [their pain] was sorted, what changes? Members, revenue, hours you work?" |
| Emotional | "And how does that feel, not having to worry about it?" |
| Visualise | "Imagine it's summer and the gym is exactly where you want it. What does a normal week look like?" |
| The gap | "Honestly, how far are you from that right now?" |

**Why the ideal criteria step matters for you:** their answers are your product spec. "I don't want another app to manage" or "it has to run itself" tells you what to build and how to pitch it.

**Log it:** next to each pain in your CRM Pains tab, add their ideal outcome and the emotion behind it. Those exact phrases make your best headlines.

## Self-check after each call

☐ Did they describe the ideal fix in their own words?

☐ Do I know the tangible result AND how it feels?

☐ Did they picture it in the present tense?

☐ Did they admit the gap between now and there?

☐ Did I still keep my product out of it?

**Next phase:** Commitment, where they confirm they are ready to act now, not later.